

Biblical Prophecy Study Guide

Seeking Truth. Studying Scripture.

A structured guide for studying biblical prophecy through Scripture, historical setting, literary context, symbols, themes, and careful interpretation.

1. Begin With the Text

Read the complete prophetic passage before focusing on individual symbols. Note repeated words, contrasts, promises, warnings, people, places, and time references.

Record what the passage actually says before moving to interpretation.

2. Study Context

Identify the speaker, audience, historical setting, literary genre, and purpose of the passage.

Compare the prophecy with its surrounding chapters and with related passages elsewhere in Scripture.

3. Identify Symbols Carefully

Prophetic books may use imagery such as beasts, horns, lamps, waters, mountains, kingdoms, or other figures. Do not assume a symbol has the same meaning everywhere.

Look for explanations provided within the passage or elsewhere in Scripture before relying on outside interpretations.

4. Consider Historical Fulfillment

Where a prophecy has an established historical setting or fulfillment, compare the biblical description with reliable historical evidence.

Keep a clear distinction between the text, documented history, and an interpretation.

5. Compare Scripture With Scripture

Cross-reference parallel themes and passages. Consider whether later biblical writers quote, develop, or interpret earlier prophetic material.

Avoid building a major conclusion on a single isolated phrase.

6. Keep Interpretation Humble

Some prophetic questions remain debated among Christians. Mark uncertain conclusions as interpretations rather than presenting them as explicit statements of Scripture.

Study patiently, distinguish evidence from inference, and keep the central message of hope and faithfulness in view.

Prophecy Study Worksheet

Passage: _____ Historical setting: _____

Key symbols: _____

Related passages: _____

Documented historical evidence: _____

Interpretation and level of confidence: _____

Pilgrim Truth • Study carefully. Ask honestly. Keep searching.